



**CMC, VELLORE, SENDS ITS GRADUATES TO OUTLYING VILLAGES TO GET HANDS-ON EXPOSURE TO RURAL HOSPITALS**

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cells, motorised hands to the indigenous rotovirus vaccine—the pipeline is varied and growing. AFMC is one of the few colleges to have research at the undergraduate level. The Indian Council of Medical Research has assigned as many as 18 projects to MBBS students here. “This is the highest a medical college has got at that level,” says Lt Gen D.P. Vats, director and commandant of AFMC.

There’s much to learn at the 105-year-old CMC. The serene ambience, away from the madding metros, is ideal for those who believe in giving back to society. There’s a wealth of clinical experience to be gained from the Community Health and Development Unit, which sends graduates to outlying villages every year for a few weeks, to get hands-on exposure to rural hospitals. “We want to create a workforce of physicians who can meet the challenges of modern medicine and at the same time be socially conscious,” says Mathew. Along with Tufts University, US, CMC is planning to bring all lectures and demos online for students working in hospitals within its network.

For a different experience, enter the Connaught Barracks in Pune. Check out the hum and buzz, the bright young faces, the breathtaking campus and doctors in crisp

white or green busy on the rounds. The place radiates the combined aura of military discipline, the pride and power of India’s armed forces along with the exuberance of a medical college. From a humble postgraduate training centre in 1948, it has grown today into a formidable institute with 29 departments, 35 courses and six affiliated hospitals—for those who want to serve the armed forces. “We prepare ‘doctor officers’ and not just doctors. They have to be mentally strong in war-prone areas, alert and also compassionate,” adds Vats.

Cash-rich corporates may have changed India’s healthcare delivery landscape, but they do not seem to have made much headway in medical education. That’s probably because the fundamental metric of most of India’s top medical schools is premised on research, in which the private sector lags seriously behind. Intellect doesn’t seem to have kowtowed to the jingle of coins in the world of medical education yet.

*with Lakshmi Subramanian and Mitali Patel*



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